

POL-008

Open Banking & Third-Party Provider Policy

Digital Banking & Payments | Retail Banking

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About this policy: This policy explains KBC's approach to open banking — how we provide secure API access, protect customers in an open banking environment, and ensure customers' data rights are always respected.

How to use this policy

This policy is written for all KBC employees. It explains what we stand for, what is expected of you, and how to handle situations you may encounter in your day-to-day work. You do not need to be a legal or compliance expert to read it. If you are ever uncertain, the right thing is always to ask. Contact details for your Compliance team are at the end of this document.

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1. Introduction

Open banking is one of the most significant changes to retail banking in a generation. It allows customers to share their financial data with third-party apps and to authorise those apps to initiate payments on their behalf. Done well, it gives customers more control over their financial lives. Done poorly, it creates new vectors for fraud and data misuse. KBC is committed to participating in open banking in a way that genuinely serves customers — enabling the benefits while rigorously managing the risks.

2. Who This Applies To

This policy applies to all KBC employees working in digital banking, payment services, product management, customer service, and compliance. It also applies to employees in technology roles responsible for maintaining KBC's open banking infrastructure.

3. What Open Banking Is

Open banking allows customers to instruct KBC to share their account information with an authorised third-party provider, or to allow that third party to initiate a payment from their account. KBC provides this access because customers have the right to control their own financial data. The value of open banking depends entirely on trust — customers trust that their data is only shared with authorised parties, only for the purposes they have consented to, and only for as long as they want it shared.

4. How KBC Provides Secure API Access

KBC provides open banking access through a dedicated, purpose-built technical interface. All third-party providers must be registered and authorised by a financial regulator. Before any data is shared or payment initiated, KBC verifies the third party's credentials and the customer's consent in real time. We maintain a fallback interface to ensure customers are never prevented from exercising their open banking rights simply because of a technical failure.

Remember: third-party access is granted by the customer, not by us

KBC facilitates access; we do not grant it. The customer decides who can see their data and who can initiate payments. Our role is to ensure those decisions are properly authenticated, recorded, and reversible.

5. Protecting Customers

Strong customer authentication is required every time a customer grants access to a new third-party provider or authorises a payment through a third-party app. Customers can revoke access to any third-party provider at any time through KBC Mobile or KBC Touch. If a customer contacts you to revoke access, action it immediately.

6. What Customers Must Know

Customers must understand that when they share their data with a third-party app, that data is subject to that third party's privacy policy — not KBC's. Help customers understand this before they grant access, particularly for

sensitive data like transaction history. If a customer has been a victim of fraud through open banking access, refer them to our fraud team immediately.

7. Your Responsibilities

- Never action a third-party access request that has not been properly authenticated.
- Revoke third-party access immediately when a customer requests it.
- Refer open banking fraud concerns to KBC Fraud Operations immediately.

8. Getting Help

- **KBC Digital Banking Team** — for technical queries.
- **KBC Compliance Advisory** — for policy guidance.
- **KBC Ethics & Compliance Helpline** — for confidential concerns.

9. Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually and following significant developments in open banking regulation or fraud typologies.